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ARTICLE

2027: The Perfect Storm Is Already Forming



BY PNW STAFF SEPTEMBER 22, 2026


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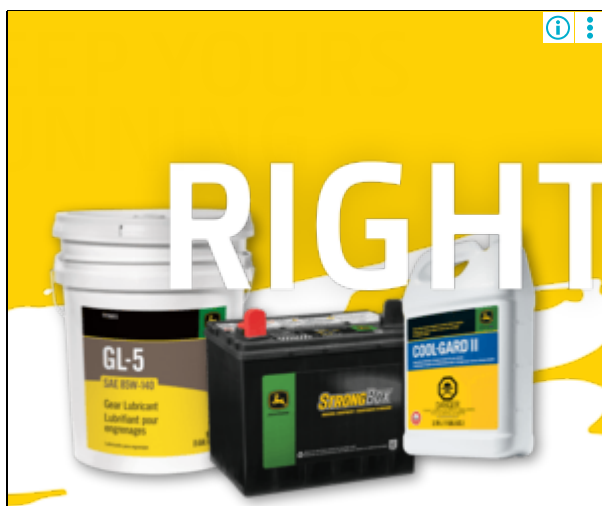
But perhaps they should be.

A remarkable collection of problems is developing across the systems that produce and transport the things Americans use every day. War is disrupting energy and fertilizer markets. Saudi oil infrastructure has been attacked. A major Midwestern refinery is offline. Fertilizer supplies have been squeezed. An exceptionally powerful El Niño is developing.

Any one of these problems can usually be absorbed.

The concern is what happens when several hit together—and when the consequences of today's disruptions don't fully appear until 2027.

That is the perfect storm now taking shape.



Why A Crisis Thousands Of Miles Away Can Reach Your Grocery Cart

Start with the Strait of Hormuz.



american, it sounds like another distant Middle Eastern shipping lane. In
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 s there can eventually affect everything from the cost of filling a
 pickup truck to the price of bread.

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The Strait normally carries enormous volumes of oil, natural gas, sulfur and fertilizer
 products. The UN Food and Agriculture Organization warned in May that disruptions

there were already tightening fertilizer markets and increasing energy costs, with
 consequences that could extend into 2027.

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Here's the connection.

Modern farms require fertilizer. Producing and transporting fertilizer requires energy. Farmers require diesel to plant and harvest crops. Trucks, trains and ships then require fuel to move those crops. Food processors require energy. Finally, trucks require still more diesel to deliver food to supermarkets.

Increase the cost or reduce the availability of several of those inputs simultaneously and the consumer eventually pays for it.

But not immediately.

That delay may be one of the most important parts of this story.

The Fertilizer Clock Is Already Ticking

Unlike many manufactured products, agriculture can't simply make up lost production next Tuesday.

Crops have planting windows. Fertilizer has application windows. Harvests happen on biological schedules.

The FAO has made precisely this point, warning that fertilizer arriving several weeks late can force farmers to use less of it or miss the application entirely. The result can be lower yields months later. Its warning specifically extends into 2027.

That creates an unsettling chain reaction:

Expensive or unavailable fertilizer today can mean less fertilizer applied to a field.



mean a smaller harvest.

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A smaller harvest means tighter supplies.

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Tighter supplies can mean higher prices for grain.

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Higher grain prices eventually work their way into cereal, bread, meat, dairy and

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countless processed foods.

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The original disruption may have happened half a world away months earlier.

The American family simply encounters the final result at checkout.



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Now Add An Energy Crisis

The same geopolitical turmoil affecting fertilizer is hitting energy.

Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline became especially important because it provides an alternative route for oil that otherwise depends on the Strait of Hormuz. Drone attacks have now damaged that infrastructure as well.

Saudi Aramco has canceled some European crude deliveries, forcing customers to seek replacement supplies elsewhere.



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ing alternative ways to move substantial amounts of crude, including transfers near Oman, so this is not the same thing as Saudi oil disappearing from the world market.

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But that distinction illustrates the larger problem

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Every workaround consumes capacity somewhere else.

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Europe searches for replacement oil. Tankers change routes. Freight costs rise. Buyers compete for alternative supplies. Refineries scramble for appropriate crude.

And eventually an overseas energy problem becomes an American price problem.

Then America's Own Refineries Start Having Problems

Now bring the crisis home.

ExxonMobil's massive Joliet refinery in Illinois was taken offline following a power outage, and floodwater later overwhelmed a pump. As of September 17, the 275,000-barrel-per-day facility remained offline. It normally produces approximately 11 million gallons of gasoline and diesel every day for the Midwest.

Think about the timing.

American farmers are harvesting crops using diesel-powered equipment while the global diesel market is already strained by war and attacks on energy infrastructure.

Now remove a major domestic refinery from the system.

It doesn't mean America's fuel supply suddenly disappears.

It means the cushion gets thinner.

And thin cushions become dangerous when the next problem arrives.

And Mother Nature May Be Preparing One

NOAA reported this week that El Niño is strengthening and now puts the probability of a



...this fall and winter above 90 percent.
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An experimental NOAA forecasting system goes even further: all 30 of its model runs

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indicate the developing El Niño could compete with some of the strongest events in the

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El Niño doesn't automatically mean agricultural disaster. Its effects differ dramatically by

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region, and in some places it can actually improve conditions.

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But that's almost beside the point.

Weather risk is arriving at precisely the moment when the global agricultural and energy systems have less room for error.

Imagine a household already struggling to pay its bills. A \$500 emergency might normally be manageable.

But what happens when the transmission fails the same week the furnace breaks and the mortgage increases?

That's essentially the danger facing the global supply system.

Why 2027 May Be When Americans Really Feel It

This is where the story becomes particularly important.

We tend to think about crises as events.



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prices jump. A factory closes.



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Agricultural crises behave differently. They move in waves.

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Fall 2026 can bring higher diesel transportation and fertilizer costs.

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Winter can bring elevated heating and energy expenses while those higher production

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costs begin moving through the food system.

Then comes the 2027 planting season.

Farmers around the world must decide how much fertilizer they can afford, what crops they will plant and how much acreage makes economic sense. Poorer nations and small farmers are especially vulnerable because they have far less ability to absorb dramatically higher input costs.

Then months later comes harvest.

Only then do we discover what those decisions—and the weather—actually produced.

That is why a fertilizer problem in 2026 can become a food problem in 2027.

The Dominoes Don't Have To Fall Perfectly

None of this means America is guaranteed to experience empty supermarkets or nationwide fuel rationing next year.

Saudi Arabia could restore its pipeline. Refineries can restart. Fertilizer markets can adapt. Other producers can increase exports. Weather can cooperate. Markets are extraordinarily good at finding alternatives when prices provide enough incentive.

In fact, Saudi Arabia's ability to reroute additional crude through Oman demonstrates exactly that resilience.

But resilience has limits.

The danger isn't one catastrophic event.

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Food depends upon fertilizer.

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Fertilizer depends upon energy and raw materials.

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Farming depends upon diesel.

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Transportation depends upon diesel.

Global trade depends upon secure shipping lanes.

Consumers depend upon all of them functioning together.

Start placing pressure on several links simultaneously and problems that once looked unrelated suddenly become one problem.

A World With Less Margin For Error

For Christians watching world events, there is another dimension worth considering.

Revelation describes a future system in which economic participation itself—buying and selling—becomes a mechanism of control.

That system does not emerge in a vacuum.

When food becomes expensive, people demand solutions.

When fuel becomes scarce, governments intervene.

When supply chains fail, rationing becomes politically acceptable.

When essential resources become difficult to obtain, populations become increasingly willing to exchange economic freedom for promises of stability, security and guaranteed access.

That is why the convergence taking place now deserves attention.

The defining economic story of 2027 may not begin in 2027 at all.

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der way—in damaged pipelines, fertilizer shortages, refinery shutdowns, disrupted shipping routes and fields where decisions being made today will determine how much food exists months from now.

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But when enough stressed systems begin failing at the same time, something very different happens.

A storm becomes a perfect storm.

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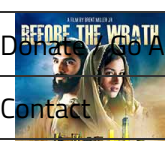
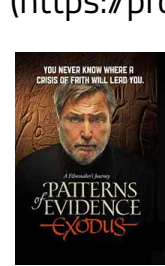
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